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CMPA 4301
September 13, 2026

Tech Hub Housing Markets Annotated Collection

My collection looks at U.S. tech hubs and whether they would make sense for a young family. As I get closer to graduating, I want to compare job opportunities and salaries with housing costs, safety, schools, childcare, parks, and commuting. A good salary matters, but I also want somewhere I would actually be comfortable raising a family.

1. BLS Metro Employment and Wages

Category: Technology Jobs and Salaries

Source: U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics. May 2025 Metropolitan and Nonmetropolitan Area Occupational Employment and Wage Estimates.

<https://www.bls.gov/oes/current/oessrcma.htm>

What it covers: The Bureau of Labor Statistics provides employment and wage estimates for occupations across U.S. metro areas, including different kinds of technology jobs.

Why it's valuable: I think this is one of my better starting points because I can compare actual job and pay data. As I get closer to graduating, I want to know where a tech career could support a young family without most of the income going toward housing.

Who would benefit: Students approaching graduation and parents comparing places for a tech career would benefit.

Limitations: The wages include experienced workers, so they are not necessarily what I would earn starting out. Employment totals also do not tell me who is currently hiring.

2. Entry Level Software Engineer Salaries

Category: Technology Jobs and Salaries

Source: Levels.fyi. Entry Level Software Engineer Salary in United States.

<https://www.levels.fyi/t/software-engineer/levels/entry-level/locations/united-states>

What it covers: This resource focuses on entry-level software engineer compensation and lets readers explore different locations. Compensation includes base salary, stock, and bonuses.

Why it's valuable: I like that it gets closer to what someone might earn after graduating. For my comparison, I would focus on base pay because I want to understand what regular income could cover for a young family, rather than plan around a larger total that includes stock.

Who would benefit: New graduates comparing offers and families planning around an early-career income would benefit.

Limitations: The submissions may not represent every employer. I would check how recent they are and compare them with BLS instead of assuming the listed amount is a guaranteed starting salary.

3. Orlando Tech Employment

Category: Technology Jobs and Salaries

Source: Neil Hamilton, Orlando Economic Partnership. Orlando Tech Employment Nears 80,000 (July 3, 2025).

<https://news.orlando.org/blog/orlando-tech-employment-nears-80000/>

What it covers: This article looks at Orlando tech employment, pay, and workforce characteristics using 2024 data. It explains the difference between technology occupations and jobs at technology companies.

Why it's valuable: Orlando is one of the Florida areas I want to look at more closely. This helps me understand the career side before comparing whether housing and everyday expenses would work for a young family.

Who would benefit: People considering a technology career in the Orlando metro would benefit.

Limitations: The publisher promotes the region, and the 2025 employment number is a projection. The salary figure is not starting pay, and the article does not tell me about schools, childcare, or specific neighborhoods.

4. Census Housing Characteristics

Category: Housing and Affordability

Source: U.S. Census Bureau. 2024 American Community Survey: Selected Housing Characteristics (DP04).

<https://data.census.gov/table/ACSDP1Y2024.DP04>

What it covers: This Census table includes home values, rent, housing expenses, and how much household income goes toward housing.

Why it's valuable: Housing is a huge part of whether I would actually consider moving somewhere. I want to compare places where a young family could have enough space without most of the income going toward rent or a mortgage. Using the same table across metros gives me a consistent starting point.

Who would benefit: Families comparing renting and buying in different areas would benefit.

Limitations: The 2024 estimates do not show current listings or what a home with the space I need would cost. I would still need to look at neighborhoods and current housing options.

5. Sarasota Housing Market Analysis

Category: Housing and Affordability

Source: U.S. Department of Housing and Urban Development, Office of Policy Development and Research. Comprehensive Housing Market Analysis: North Port-Sarasota-Bradenton, Florida (April 1, 2025).

<https://www.huduser.gov/portal/publications/pdf/NorthPortSarasotaBradentonFL-CHMA-25.pdf>

What it covers: This HUD report looks at employment, population growth, home sales, rentals, construction, and expected housing demand in the North Port-Sarasota-Bradenton area.

Why it's valuable: Sarasota is somewhere I would actually consider living, so I wanted a closer look at that housing market. It helps me understand the area before figuring out whether it would make sense for a young family and a technology career.

Who would benefit: Families considering Sarasota or Bradenton who want more than a single home-price number would benefit.

Limitations: The report reflects April 2025 conditions, and its forecasts are estimates. It does not answer my questions about specific schools, neighborhood safety, or the availability of tech jobs.

6. Zillow Housing Data

Category: Housing and Affordability

Source: Zillow Research. Housing Data.

<https://www.zillow.com/research/data/>

What it covers: Zillow offers downloadable information on typical rents, home values, and the income needed to rent or buy in different areas.

Why it's valuable: I want actual dollar amounts alongside the broader cost comparisons. For a young family, I would want to know what housing with enough bedrooms could cost, rather than assume the cheapest apartment would meet my needs.

Who would benefit: Families comparing housing options and people trying to connect local pay with housing costs would benefit.

Limitations: The overall rent measure is not a quote for a particular home or bedroom count. I would match the dates and housing types where available, then check real listings in the neighborhoods I am considering.

7. Redfin Housing Data

Category: Housing and Affordability

Source: Redfin. Redfin Data Center.

<https://www.redfin.com/news/data-center/>

What it covers: Redfin provides housing market trackers, downloadable data, and information about starter homes. Its datasets have different update schedules.

Why it's valuable: I like having something that follows recent market changes. If I am comparing places where a young family could eventually buy a home, older averages alone would not give me enough information about what is happening now.

Who would benefit: Families considering their first home and people comparing housing trends between areas would benefit.

Limitations: A starter home is not automatically the right size or in the right location for every family. I would check the geography and reporting period, then research schools, commuting, and the full cost of owning a particular home.

8. BEA Regional Price Parities

Category: Cost of Living

Source: U.S. Bureau of Economic Analysis. Regional Price Parities by State and Metro Area.

<https://www.bea.gov/data/prices-inflation/regional-price-parities-state-and-metro-area>

What it covers: This BEA source compares price levels across states and metro areas using Regional Price Parities. It also links to interactive tables and maps.

Why it's valuable: A higher salary does not mean as much if everything around me costs more. I can use this alongside wage and housing data to compare how far an income might go when supporting a young family.

Who would benefit: Families comparing job locations and people trying to understand differences in purchasing power would benefit.

Limitations: The index is an overall comparison, not a family budget. It will not tell me exactly what childcare, insurance, or the housing I need would cost, so those expenses still need a closer look.

9. MIT Living Wage Calculator

Category: Cost of Living

Source: Living Wage Institute via MIT Living Wage Calculator. Living Wage Calculator.

<https://livingwage.mit.edu/>

What it covers: This calculator estimates the income needed for basic expenses across different household types, including households with children. It provides county, metro, and state results.

Why it's valuable: I think this fits my priorities well because housing is only part of raising a family. I can compare household situations with children and look at costs such as childcare and food instead of using a budget for a single person.

Who would benefit: Young families comparing places to live or different working arrangements would benefit.

Limitations: The estimates cover basic needs, not every expense or savings goal. I would select the household type that fits and adjust for actual childcare arrangements, debt, and other personal costs.

10. FBI Reported Crime Statistics

Category: Safety and Quality of Life

Source: Federal Bureau of Investigation. FBI Releases 2024 Reported Crimes in the Nation Statistics (August 5, 2025).

<https://www.fbi.gov/news/press-releases/fbi-releases-2024-reported-crimes-in-the-nation-statistics>

What it covers: This FBI release summarizes national crime statistics for 2024 and links to the Crime Data Explorer for more detailed information.

Why it's valuable: Safety would matter a lot to me when deciding where to raise a young family. I wanted an official source to help check what I read online, because a few comments about a city would not be enough to judge an entire area.

Who would benefit: Parents and other people beginning to research safety before a move would benefit.

Limitations: The release is a national overview from an earlier year. I would need newer local data and neighborhood research, and reported crime figures do not capture everything that affects how safe a place feels.

11. Austin Community Survey

Category: Safety and Quality of Life

Source: City of Austin and ETC Institute. 2025 Community Survey (results released May 15, 2026).

<https://www.austintexas.gov/budget-excellence/community-survey>

What it covers: This survey asks Austin residents about city services, quality of life, and community priorities. The dashboard includes results from previous years as well.

Why it's valuable: I want to know how residents feel about the place they live, especially when thinking about a young family. Their feedback gives me another way to look at everyday life beyond jobs and housing prices.

Who would benefit: Families considering Austin who want to understand what residents appreciate and want improved would benefit.

Limitations: The survey covers the city, not the whole metro, and it includes different kinds of households. I would still need to research the particular neighborhoods, schools, and family services that matter to me.

12. Raleigh Community Survey

Category: Safety and Quality of Life

Source: City of Raleigh and ETC Institute. 2024 Community Survey (findings presented May 6, 2025).

<https://raleighnc.gov/government/services/community-survey>

What it covers: This Raleigh survey covers resident satisfaction with quality of life, city services, and the city as a place to work. Housing, growth, and transportation are among the concerns residents identify.

Why it's valuable: I like that it includes things people enjoy along with problems they want addressed. Those concerns matter to a young family because housing costs and time spent commuting can affect everyday life even when a job looks good.

Who would benefit: Families considering Raleigh who want a broader picture of resident opinions would benefit.

Limitations: The results are from the 2024 survey and cover Raleigh city limits. They do not describe every suburb or tell me which school or neighborhood would fit my needs.

13. CBRE Scoring Tech Talent

Category: Overall Tech-Hub Comparisons

Source: CBRE Research. Scoring Tech Talent 2026 (August 18, 2026).

<https://www.cbre.com/insights/books/scoring-tech-talent-2026>

What it covers: This report compares North American tech talent markets and discusses employment trends, workforce size, and changes related to artificial intelligence.

Why it's valuable: I want to know whether an area has enough technology opportunities before considering a move. For a young family, I think it is worth looking beyond one job offer and asking what other options might be available if that job did not work out.

Who would benefit: People comparing tech markets while thinking about their family's future would benefit.

Limitations: The report mainly supports business decisions, and a strong ranking does not mean a city is affordable for a new graduate. I would check U.S. market boundaries and compare its findings with family living costs.

14. Tampa Bay Regional Competitiveness

Category: Overall Tech-Hub Comparisons

Source: Tampa Bay Partnership. 2026 Regional Competitiveness Report.

<https://stateoftheregion.com/2026-highlights/>

What it covers: This report compares Tampa Bay with other communities using information about wages, housing, talent, transportation, and economic opportunity.

Why it's valuable: Tampa is one of the Florida areas I want in my collection. I like that this source looks at several parts of living and working there, because growth alone would not tell me whether a young family could afford a good life in the area.

Who would benefit: Families researching Tampa Bay and people comparing its economy with other regions would benefit.

Limitations: The report uses an eight-county region that is larger than the Tampa MSA. I would keep those figures separate and check the data years before comparing them with my other metro sources.

15. Alternative Tech Cities Discussion

Category: Community Perspectives

Source: u/allllusernamestaken and commenters, Reddit r/SameGrassButGreener. "B-list" Tech Cities That Are Actually Nice Places to Live?.

https://www.reddit.com/r/SameGrassButGreener/comments/1q0vtee/blist_tech_cities_that_are_actually_nice_places/

What it covers: This discussion asks about alternatives to the biggest tech cities and includes opinions about jobs, climate, food, and access to nature.

Why it's valuable: I wanted personal perspectives alongside the statistics. Some comments can give me ideas about places to research, especially when people discuss outdoor activities or the general feel of an area. I would then look more closely at whether those places fit a young family.

Who would benefit: People exploring possible tech cities and deciding what to investigate next would benefit.

Limitations: The discussion is not specifically about raising children. Comments reflect individual priorities, and I would need separate evidence about schools, childcare, safety, and job opportunities before using it to narrow down a move.

16. Pittsburgh Resident Reviews

Category: Community Perspectives

Source: Niche contributors. Pittsburgh PA Reviews.

<https://www.niche.com/places-to-live/pittsburgh-allegheny-pa/reviews/>

What it covers: This page contains written reviews of Pittsburgh, including comments about neighborhoods, activities, weather, transportation, and housing affordability.

Why it's valuable: I think hearing about daily life is useful when I have not lived somewhere myself. For a young family, I would pay more attention to what people say about their neighborhood and getting around than to entertainment aimed at singles.

Who would benefit: Families beginning to research Pittsburgh and looking for questions to ask about particular areas would benefit.

Limitations: The reviews are not a representative survey, and not every reviewer is a parent. I would check dates and locations and use separate sources to verify claims about schools, safety, and costs.

17. Comparing Six Cities for a Tech Career

Category: Community Perspectives

Source: u/I-already-redd-it- and commenters, Reddit r/SameGrassButGreener. Looking at these 6 places, which fits the criteria best? (January 2026).

https://www.reddit.com/r/SameGrassButGreener/comments/1qewuqf/looking_at_these_6_places_which_fits_the_criteria/

What it covers: This discussion follows a 22-year-old comparing six cities based on technology opportunities, social life, and cost of living.

Why it's valuable: The career and affordability tradeoffs still connect with my topic. I can use the discussion to notice questions about job access and housing, while recognizing that I am more interested in what a place offers a young family.

Who would benefit: New graduates weighing different locations would benefit, especially those beginning to decide which factors matter most.

Limitations: The poster focuses on dating, social life, and an individual budget, so this is a weaker fit for my priorities. It does not answer questions about schools or childcare, and commenters' financial and hiring claims need verification.

18. Raleigh and Durham Relocation Discussion

Category: Community Perspectives

Source: u/AdeptImplement898 and commenters, Reddit r/SameGrassButGreener. RDU for 29m (January 2026).

https://www.reddit.com/r/SameGrassButGreener/comments/1qnmvvv/rdu_for_29m/

What it covers: This thread discusses a possible job move to Raleigh or Durham, with replies about downtown living, activities, walkability, and suburban differences.

Why it's valuable: I think the distinction between downtown and the suburbs is useful. Where I would live with a young family might be very different from where someone seeking a busy social scene would choose, even within the same general area.

Who would benefit: People comparing parts of the Triangle and trying to understand how location changes daily life would benefit.

Limitations: The original question focuses on dating and social life, making it less useful for my family priorities. I would need other sources for schools and childcare and would keep Raleigh and Durham tagged separately.

19. Tampa Resident Reviews

Category: Community Perspectives

Source: Niche contributors. Tampa FL Reviews.

<https://www.niche.com/places-to-live/tampa-hillsborough-fl/reviews/>

What it covers: These Tampa reviews include residents' opinions about local activities, traffic, construction, and housing costs, along with other aspects of living in the area.

Why it's valuable: Tampa is somewhere I want to understand beyond the housing averages. I would use these accounts to notice concerns about getting around and finding an affordable place to live, then look at how those issues could affect a young family.

Who would benefit: Families beginning to explore Tampa and nearby neighborhoods would benefit.

Limitations: The comments are self-selected and sometimes refer to the wider Tampa Bay area. A positive review does not establish that a neighborhood has the schools, safety, or childcare options I would want.

20. Orlando Resident Reviews

Category: Community Perspectives

Source: Niche contributors. Orlando FL Reviews.

<https://www.niche.com/places-to-live/orlando-orange-fl/reviews/>

What it covers: This page collects opinions about life in Orlando, including entertainment, community, commuting, and the cost of living.

Why it's valuable: I want to understand Orlando as a place to raise a young family, not just somewhere to visit. Comments about everyday expenses and travel between places give me things to investigate before assuming that having plenty of attractions makes it a good fit.

Who would benefit: Families considering Orlando who want personal perspectives alongside housing and wage data would benefit.

Limitations: Reviewers have different priorities, and some claims may be inaccurate. I would verify information about transportation, jobs, and costs and separately research schools, childcare, parks, and the neighborhoods where I could actually afford to live.